## NAME

**txt2latex** - convert flat ASCII text to LaTeX.

## SYNOPSIS

`txt2latex [OPTION...] FILE`

## DESCRIPTION

**txt2latex** converts the input text into LaTeX.

If the input file *FILE* is omitted, standard input is used. The result is displayed on standard output.

**txt2latex** is also able to recognize sections, paragraphs, lists (itemize, enumerate, description), verbatim blocks, as well as inline math and equations.

The formatting rules are heavily inspired by **txt2man**(1) to maximize compatibility with plain text written as man pages. The same source text can be directly converted to LaTeX without relying on intermediary conversion steps. Nonetheless, the main objective of **txt2latex** is not to parse man-formatted plain text but to convert any plain text to LaTeX.

The rules for processing the text patterns are defined as following:

**Sections**
They are defined by a line in upper case starting at column 1. Preceding blank lines are allowed for better visualization.

**Paragraphs**
They must be left aligned and preceded by a blank line. Blank spaces at the beginning of the paragraphs are allowed and there is no restriction on line alignement in a paragraph. Nonetheless, identical alignment provides a better visualization of the plain ASCII text.

**Description list**
Labels of the items are separated from the definitions by at least 2 blank spaces, even before a new line, if definition is too long.

**Itemize (bullet) list**
Bullet list items are defined by the first character being "-", "*" or "o" followed by a space.

**Enumerated list**
Enumerated lists are defined by the first character being a number followed by a dot or a rounded bracket.

**Nested lists**
Nested and mixed lists are allowed.

**Verbatim block**
Verbatim block is used to display unmodified text such as quotes of source code. They must be separated by a blank line and be indented with respect to the previuous line. It will be printed using the verbatim environment.

**Mathematics**
Inline mathematics must be enclosed with a simple $ sign and equations must be enclosed with double $ signs. For example, $E=mc^2$ is rendered as an inline math whereas $$ E=mc^2 $$ is rendered in a simple equation environment.

**Tables** There is no support for tables. The workaround is put them in a verbatim block.

Special characters #, $, %, &, _, {, }, ^,  are protected i.e. escaped.

Symbols such as <, >, <=, >= are converted to inline math.

Special words such as LaTeX and TeX are turned into their equivalent commands in latex.

## OPTIONS

**-d date** Set date. Defaults to current date.

**-t mytitle**
Set the title. If the title is set, **txt2latex** will automatically add all the markups necessary to create a standalone latex document that can be compiled with pdflatex. Xelatex and lualatex are not supported.

**-a author**
Set the author.

**-s shift** Shift heading level by 0 (section), 1 (subsection), or 2 (subsection). Defaults to 0.

**-m, --man**
Apply some special formatting for man pages. See NOTES.

**-I txt** Italicize txt in output. Can be specified more than once.

**-B txt** Emphasize (bold) txt in output. Can be specified more than once.

**-M txt** Monospace txt in output. Can be specified more than once.

**-P package**
Add packages or LaTeX or TeX commands in the preambule.

**-v, --version**
Display version.

**-h, --help**
Display help.

## NOTES

The option **-m** is an alpha feature and fully implemented. The formatting is done by applying the adequate preambule in a standalone document for matching the rendering of man **-Tpdf**. For now:

- SYNOPSIS section is formatted as monospaced text.
- Set font to times.
- Set correct paragraph indentation.

## EXAMPLES

Simple conversion

```
$ txt2latex FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with document title

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" FILE > FILE.tex
```

Conversion with custom packages and direct rendering with pdflatex

```
$ txt2latex -t "title" -a "author" -I "word" -P "\usepackage{ccfonts}" -X FIL
```

Try this command to format this text itself and to produce a pdf:

```
$ txt2latex -h 2>&1 | txt2latex -t "txt2latex(1)" -a "User commands" --man |
```

Compare it to the man page generated by **txt2man**(1):

```
$ txt2latex -h 2>&1 | txt2man -s 1 -t txt2latex -v "User commands" -r 0.3.0 |
```

## SEE ALSO

**txt2man**(1)